

CHALLENGING TIMES



The Indian IT sector is the largest avenue of white-collar jobs for tech professionals in the country



Stagnant salaries, cutbacks on variable pay and benefits, delay in on-boarding, etc., have resulted in lower employee satisfaction



The industry was once known for sharing profits and benefits down the line, but the times have changed



Dwindling employee loyalty is leading to high attrition rates, moonlighting, quiet quitting, etc.

WIDENING GAP

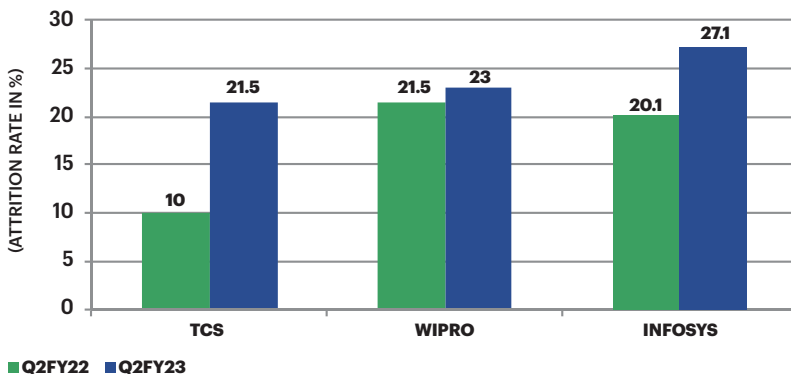
The increasing gulf between bosses' and freshers' pay

	CEO SALARY (₹ CRORE)		FRESHER SALARY (₹ LAKH)	
	2012	2022	2012	2022
TCS	8	26	1.6	4
INFOSYS	0.8	79	2.75	3.6
WIPRO	5.1	79	2.4	3.5
HCL	8.4	124	3	3.5
TECH MAHINDRA	1	63	2.5	3.4
AVERAGE SALARY*	4.66	74.2	2.45	3.6

*AVERAGE FIGURE HAS BEEN CALCULATED BASED ON THE SALARIES OF THE FIVE COMPANIES; **SOURCE** ANNUAL RESULTS OF COMPANIES

DWINDLING LOYALTIES

High attrition rate has become a problem for Indian IT companies



SOURCE EARNINGS REPORT

GRAPHICS BY **RAHUL SHARMA**

leave jobs. This made it easier for them to switch jobs," she says.

Research also backs this statement. A recent study by tech giant HP Inc. noted that Indian employees are more likely to stay in their current job if they are given a hybrid work option. Per the study, 88 per cent of the respondents agreed that hybrid work increases employee retention.

But attrition is a matter of serious concern because it comes with a price tag for the company. "The cost of attrition comprises three things: when an employee leaves the company, the position needs to be filled soon because there is loss of productivity—this is one part of the cost; the next part is the cost of finding a replacement; then when the replacement starts working... they need to be trained; this makes up another part of the cost of attrition," explains Udernani.

But high attrition is not the only issue pointing towards dwindling employee loyalty. Buzzwords like moonlighting and quiet quitting have also started creeping into the Indian IT sector.

Yeshab Giri, Chief Commercial Officer of Staffing at Randstad Technologies, an IT recruitment solutions company, says slipping employee loyalty might create a host of other problems. "Some of the major challenges that the IT industry is facing now include employee retention, controlling attrition, managing employee burnout, quiet quitting, and moonlighting. In fact, moonlighting is one of the major concerns for IT companies as it might lead to malpractices like conflict of interest and breach of confidentiality in terms of data and other information," he says.

Moonlighting, in particular, has divided the sector, with myriad ways being employed by various firms to deal with it, without any